



BIG LEAGUE: Leaders of the NSG countries



VETO POWER: A joint sitting of the US Congress

Nuclear Suppliers Group

ACTION: After IAEA safeguards are agreed upon, the 45-member NSG has to have a consensus vote on lifting the ban on nuclear trade as America has done.

DIFFICULTY: Some countries like China are opposed to the deal and have to be worked on. Getting the NSG to ratify it quickly will be an issue.

DEADLINE Clearance by November 2007

Korea, Australia, New Zealand, Brazil and Argentina to enlist their support. He has reported that the mood was "positive" for lifting of the nuclear ban against India. The Government is also working to persuade countries like China, which may veto the deal, to go along with the emerging consensus. After the US calls for an extraordinary meeting, it would take around two to three months for the NSG to give its approval.

So the best case scenario is for the two governments to push for a vote by the US Congress on the 123 in the first quarter of 2008. The Congress will take at least 90 days to deliberate on the Agreement before taking the up and down vote on it. This means it would either ratify it in its

The US Congress

ACTION: After the IAEA safeguards and the NSG consent, the US Congress has to meet to discuss the 123 Agreement and ratify it with an up and down vote.

DIFFICULTY: Congress will go into election mode by March 2008. The ratification will have to be pushed through before that, otherwise the odds for it will dwindle.

DEADLINE Ratification by March 2008

entirety or reject it. After that, India would still have to align its domestic Atomic Energy Act to permit private sector participation in nuclear generation and also address the issue of liability in case of nuclear accidents. If the IAEA process gets delayed beyond a month, the odds of the deal not going through increase. So far, the gameplan of the Left and BJP seems to be just that. The Government hopes that better sense would prevail and they could push ahead with the deal.

That both the Left and BJP did not cry murder over the nuclear deal when the Hyde Act was signed into law by President Bush on December 18, 2006, may end up being their strategic folly. It could well turn the tide of the debate in the Government's favour at both the committee meetings